SETUP GUIDE / OCTOBER 2026

Register Google sign-in

Create the Google OAuth web client used to sign in to your own Personal Archive admin area.

This application requests Google identity only. It does not need Gmail, Drive, Calendar, or other Google API access.

What you will need

- A Google account with access to Google Cloud Console.
- The exact base URL for this installation. For local development use `http://localhost:3000`; for a public server use its final HTTPS domain.
- The administrator Google email address, which must be added both to Google's test-user list (while the OAuth app is in Testing) and to Personal Archive's `ADMIN_EMAILS` allowlist.

1. Create or select a Cloud project

Open Google Cloud Console. Create a project for this installation, or select an existing project that you control. The project keeps this site's sign-in configuration and client secret separate from other sites.

2. Configure Google Auth Platform

In the selected project, open Google Auth Platform. Complete the Branding and Audience pages. Console labels may change over time; Google currently groups consent-screen setup under these pages.

- Branding: give the app a recognizable name and set a support email you control.
- Audience: choose External for a normal personal Google account. If this is restricted to a Google Workspace organization, Internal may be appropriate.
- For a private one-owner installation, leave Publishing status as Testing and add your own account under Test users. Only listed testers can authorize an External app in Testing mode.
- Keep the requested identity scopes to the defaults: openid, email, and profile. Do not add other Google API scopes for this project.

3. Create a Web application client

Open Clients, choose Create client, and select Web application. Name it so you recognize the site, for example `Personal Archive - home server`.

In Authorized redirect URIs, add exactly one callback for the URL you will use:

```
Local development: http://localhost:3000/api/auth/callback/google
Public site: https://your-domain.example/api/auth/callback/google
```

For this server-side sign-in flow, Authorized JavaScript origins can remain empty. Save the client. Google displays a Client ID and Client secret; keep both private. The redirect URI must match exactly, including scheme, hostname, port, path, and trailing slash behavior.

Connect the client to your site

4. Set the Personal Archive environment

Put these values in the private `.env` file for the same installation. Do not commit it or paste the client secret into issues, screenshots, or public chat.

```
SITE_URL=https://your-domain.example
AUTH_URL=https://your-domain.example
AUTH_SECRET=<long-random-secret>
AUTH_GOOGLE_ID=<client-id-from-google>
AUTH_GOOGLE_SECRET=<client-secret-from-google>
ADMIN_EMAILS=you@example.com
```

- Set SITE_URL and AUTH_URL to the site's public origin, with no path after the domain. For a local-only install, use http://localhost:3000 for both.
- Generate AUTH_SECRET with `openssl rand -base64 32` or a secure random generator. Do not reuse the Google client secret as AUTH_SECRET.
- Put the exact Google account email into ADMIN_EMAILS. Separate multiple authorized administrator addresses with commas.
- Restart the Next.js server after changing environment values so the application loads the new client credentials.

5. Test the sign-in

- Open `/admin` on your site and choose Sign in with Google.
- Complete Google's sign-in using the account listed in ADMIN_EMAILS. In Testing mode that same account must also be listed as a Google test user.
- Confirm you reach the admin dashboard. Sign out, then verify an account not in ADMIN_EMAILS is refused.

Keep a private single-owner site in Testing mode. If you later want unrelated Google users to authorize the OAuth app, review Google's current publishing, domain, branding, and verification requirements before changing its audience or publishing status.

Troubleshooting

Redirect URI mismatch	The callback in Google does not exactly match the active SITE_URL/AUTH_URL. Check http vs https, hostname, port, and /api/auth/callback/google.
Access denied	Check that the signed-in account is a Google Test user while the app is in Testing, and that its address is included in ADMIN_EMAILS.
Configuration error	Check AUTH_SECRET, AUTH_GOOGLE_ID, AUTH_GOOGLE_SECRET, SITE_URL and AUTH_URL, then restart the app.

Production reminder

A public server must use HTTPS. Use its final HTTPS origin in SITE_URL, AUTH_URL, and Google's authorized callback before inviting sign-in. The full server and backup procedure is in DEPLOY.md.

Google's Console screens and verification rules can change. Steps checked October 14, 2026. Official references: Google client ID setup, OAuth web-server guide, and production readiness.